the prime minister. It was the speech delivered by Yair Garbuz, a painter and art professor who railed against the “amulet kissers [and] idol worshippers”. They had taken over, he warned, and the coming election offered reasonable Israelis a last chance to reclaim their country from the “freaks”, the “destroyers of democracy”.

It was a not-so-thinly veiled reference to Mizrahi Jews: their hand-shaped *hamsa* amulets, their saints—their “Arab” traditions. His insults were soon blasted out to supporters of the Likud party, which was worried about a low turnout; on election day, not a few right-wing voters cited Garbuz as their reason for going to the polls. “Garbuz’s speech hurt us, without a shadow of a doubt,” Isaac Herzog, the leader of the Labor party and Netanyahu’s main challenger, acknowledged a few days after the vote.

This was fertile ground for Regev. But only to a point. In the summer of 2016, Army Radio broadcast a poem by Mahmoud Darwish as part of an educational segment. Darwish, born in the Galilee in 1941, is widely regarded as the Palestinian national poet. He spent much of his adult life in exile after joining the PLO, and gave an eloquent voice to Palestinian feelings of dispossession. So his words can be challenging to Israeli ears. The late Yossi Sarid, a left-wing former education minister, tried to introduce them into the national curriculum in 2000, but backed down after provoking a furious reaction in the Knesset.

Twelve years later, though, a successor agreed to teach Darwish to high school literature students. This meant it should have been uncontroversial when Army Radio read one of his most famous poems, “Identity Card,” best known for its defiant refrain “*sajjil, ana ‘arabi”*, “write down, I am an Arab.”

But the Israeli right was incandescent: a Palestinian national symbol on their airwaves, and on an army-run station to boot. “The IDF radio station has gone off the rails,” Regev complained. Avigdor Lieberman went further, summoning the director of the station for a dressing-down, and then comparing Darwish to Hitler. “By the same logic,” he argued, “[Army Radio could] broadcast a glorification of the literary marvels of Adolf Hitler’s *Mein Kampf*.” (Darwish, for the record, was not an anti-Semite.)

A few months later, an artistic duo read the same lines at the Ophir Awards, the Israeli equivalent of the Oscars. One of the performers was Tamer Nafar, a co-founder of DAM, the first Palestinian Israeli rap group. The other was Yossi Tzabari—a Mizrahi Jewish artist. They performed a